

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 459

By Pody

A RESOLUTION to honor Mary Decker upon her career in special needs education.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should recognize those outstanding citizens who devoted their careers to teaching special needs students; and

WHEREAS, Mary Decker distinguished herself as a professional of the greatest dedication, ability, and integrity during her tenure with the Anoka-Hennepin School District in Minnesota from 1991 to 2015, when she retired from teaching; and

WHEREAS, she began her career there as a paraprofessional working in elementary classrooms and then served as a long-term substitute teacher in special needs classrooms of all categories; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Decker next served as a special needs teacher at Anoka High School and Blaine High School and then concluded her career as a reading teacher for struggling readers at Blaine High School; and

WHEREAS, for fifteen of the seventeen years she was an employee of the school district, she was a homebound teacher for all categories of special needs students; and

WHEREAS, Mary Decker received her Bachelor of Science degree in Elementary Education with a minor in Special Education from St. Cloud State University and later earned a master's degree in Education and Reading Instructional Licensure from Hamline University; she also completed training in the Sonday System for teaching reading to students with dyslexia; and

WHEREAS, after retiring and relocating to the Volunteer State, she volunteered at a local elementary school for a time and still maintains her membership at Love's Way Church in Lebanon, where she practices her faith; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Decker is most appreciative of the love, support, and companionship she shares with her beloved husband of fifty years, Randall Decker, who was a school bus

driver for special needs students in Minnesota; their daughters, Cathleen Brown and Kristin Milbrath; and their grandchildren, Logan Brown, Kayden Brown, and Caleb Brown; and

WHEREAS, during her distinguished tenure in the classroom, Mary Decker was wholly committed to the highest ideals of public service and quality education for special needs students, and she should be specially recognized; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor Mary Decker upon her outstanding career in special needs education and extend to her our best wishes for continued success and happiness in her future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.